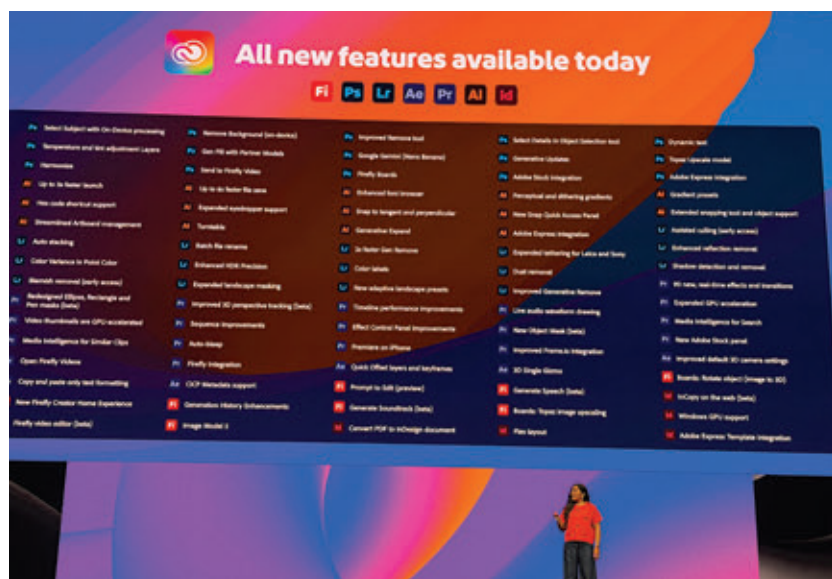




# Adobe on balancing AI innovation with regulation

And why India matters more than ever

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**G**enAI is reshaping the creative and business landscape at an unprecedented pace. This is making it rather challenging for big tech companies to balance innovation with regulation. Adobe, the biggest creative company in the world, which is also at the forefront of the AI revolution is also facing the same problem. Adobe's Chief Legal Officer, Louise Pentland shared insights on the company's approach to responsible AI development, its global regulatory strategy and why India remains central to Adobe's future.

When asked about navigating regulatory complexities in India -- a market

where technology often moves faster than policy -- Pentland underscored the importance of local engagement and cultural understanding.

"We have a big presence in India," she said, noting that Adobe has built deep relationships with the Indian government through years of collaboration. "We have people from our government relations team in India, on site, because in markets like that, it's impossible to manage everything from the United States. There's so much nuance, so much differentiation."

India is not just a market for Adobe. It's a center of innovation and talent. The country's role in shaping global

technology conversations is expanding rapidly, something Adobe recognises through its participation in upcoming AI-focused events in India. "The market is super interesting," Pentland added. "There's so much innovation happening there. We're certainly very active in thinking about how we would participate in events like that as well."

## Finding the right balance

Globally, governments are scrambling to regulate AI, often trying to catch up with the speed of innovation. Pentland believes the key lies in "evolution, not overregulation."

"I always caution governments not to over-regulate," she said. "The worst thing we can do right now is stifle innovation. Regulation has to evolve."

She pointed to the European Union's flexible regulatory framework as an example of progress, one that allows AI policies to adapt over time rather than be locked into rigid definitions. "They created a lot more bandwidth in the regulation to allow it to evolve," Pentland explained. "That's the kind of balance we need understanding what governments are concerned about, but ensuring we don't suffocate innovation."

For countries like India, where comprehensive data protection or AI laws are still developing, Pentland believes the onus lies on companies.

"Even before regulations came out, Adobe took a very ethical approach," she said. "We were one of the first to talk about being commercially safe. We've been very forward-leaning on things like content credentials, making sure that content has good provenance."

This self-regulatory approach is part of Adobe's broader philosophy: that ethical innovation is a competitive advantage, not an afterthought. "One of the reasons I came to Adobe is because it genuinely wants to be a good company," Pentland reflected. "It wants to represent and protect the creative community's interests." **[d]**